PEW RESEARCH CENTER/NATIONAL JOURNAL
CONGRESSIONAL CONNECTION POLL
MAY 13-16, 2010
FINAL TOPLINE
N=1002

ASK ALL:
PEW.1 All in all, are you satisfied or dissatisfied with the way things are going in this country today?

	Satis-fied	Dis-satisfied	(VOL.) DK/Ref
May 13-16, 2010	28	64	7
Apr 21-26, 2010	29	66	5
Apr 1-5, 2010	31	63	6
Mar 11-21, 2010	25	69	5
Mar 10-14, 2010	23	71	7
Feb 3-9, 2010	23	71	6
Jan 6-10, 2010	27	69	4
Oct 28-Nov 8, 2009	25	67	7
Sep 30-Oct 4, 2009	25	67	7
Sep 10-15, 2009[1]	30	64	7
Aug 20-27, 2009	28	65	7
Aug 11-17, 2009	28	65	7
Jul 22-26, 2009	28	66	6
Jun 10-14, 2009	30	64	5
Apr 28-May 12, 2009	34	58	8
Apr 14-21, 2009	23	70	7
Jan 7-11, 2009	20	73	7
December, 2008	13	83	4
Early October, 2008	11	86	3
Mid-September, 2008	25	69	6
August, 2008	21	74	5
July, 2008	19	74	7
June, 2008	19	76	5
Late May, 2008	18	76	6
March, 2008	22	72	6
Early February, 2008	24	70	6
Late December, 2007	27	66	7
October, 2007	28	66	6
February, 2007	30	61	9
Mid-January, 2007	32	61	7
Early January, 2007	30	63	7
December, 2006	28	65	7
Mid-November, 2006	28	64	8
Early October, 2006	30	63	7
July, 2006	30	65	5
May, 2006*	29	65	6
March, 2006	32	63	5
January, 2006	34	61	5
Late November, 2005	34	59	7
Early October, 2005	29	65	6
July, 2005	35	58	7
Late May, 2005*	39	57	4
February, 2005	38	56	6
January, 2005	40	54	6
December, 2004	39	54	7
Mid-October, 2004	36	58	6
July, 2004	38	55	7
May, 2004	33	61	6
Late February, 2004*	39	55	6
Early January, 2004	45	48	7
December, 2003	44	47	9
October, 2003	38	56	6
August, 2003	40	53	7
April 8, 2003	*50*	*41*	*9*
January, 2003	44	50	6
November, 2002	41	48	11
September, 2002	41	55	4
Late August, 2002	47	44	9
May, 2002	44	44	12
March, 2002	50	40	10
Late September, 2001	57	34	9
Early September, 2001	41	53	6
June, 2001	43	52	5
March, 2001	47	45	8
February, 2001	46	43	11
January, 2001	55	41	4
October, 2000 *(RVs)*	54	39	7
September, 2000	51	41	8
June, 2000	47	45	8
April, 2000	48	43	9
August, 1999	56	39	5
January, 1999	53	41	6
November, 1998	46	44	10
Early September, 1998	54	42	4
Late August, 1998	55	41	4
Early August, 1998	50	44	6
February, 1998	59	37	4
January, 1998	46	50	4
September, 1997	45	49	6
August, 1997	49	46	5
January, 1997	38	58	4
July, 1996	29	67	4
March, 1996	28	70	2
October, 1995	23	73	4
June, 1995	25	73	2

[1] From September 10-15, 2009 and other surveys noted with an asterisk, the question was worded "Overall, are you satisfied or dissatisfied with the way things are going in our country today?"

Q.1 CONTINUED

	Satis-fied	Dis-satisfied	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
April, 1995	23	74	3
July, 1994	24	73	3
March, 1994	24	71	5
October, 1993	22	73	5
September, 1993	20	75	5
May, 1993	22	71	7
January, 1993	39	50	11
January, 1992	28	68	4
November, 1991	34	61	5
Late February, 1991 *(Gallup)*	66	31	3
August, 1990	47	48	5
May, 1990	41	54	5
January, 1989	45	50	5
September, 1988 *(RVs)*	50	45	5

ASK ALL:

PEW.2 Now I'd like to ask your impression of some groups and individuals. Would you say **[INSERT ITEM; RANDOMIZE]** is doing an excellent, good, only fair, or a poor job? How about **[NEXT ITEM]? [IF NECESSARY:** would you say **[ITEM]** is doing an excellent, good, only fair, or a poor job?**]**

		Excellent	Good	Only fair	Poor	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
a.	Congress					
	May 13-16, 2010	2	11	38	44	5
	Mar 11-21, 2010	2	15	40	40	3
b.	Barack Obama[2]					
	May 13-16, 2010	12	27	31	27	3
	Mar 11-21, 2010	10	30	28	30	3

ASK ALL:

PEW.3 How much confidence do you have that the government in Washington D.C. will make progress over the next year on the most important problems facing the country? **[READ IN ORDER]**

May 13-16 2010	
10	A lot of confidence
32	Some confidence
31	Not much confidence [OR]
25	No confidence at all
2	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**

[2] March 11-21 survey asked about "the Obama administration."

ASK ALL:

PEW.4 Over the coming months, how important is it for Congress to act on each of the following? First, is passing legislation to [**INSERT ITEM; RANDOMIZE**] very important, somewhat important, not too important or not at all important? What about legislation to **[NEXT ITEM]? (IF NECESSARY:** Is passing legislation to **[ITEM]** very, somewhat, not too, or not at all important?**)**

		Very important	Somewhat important	No too important	Not at all important	**(VOL.)** Oppose/ not needed	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref
a.	More strictly regulate financial institutions and markets						
	May 13-16, 2010	54	28	7	6	*	5
b.	Address the job situation						
	May 13-16, 2010	81	13	2	2	*	2
c.	Address climate change						
	May 13-16, 2010	32	33	13	16	1	4
d.	Address immigration policy						
	May 13-16, 2010	59	27	8	4	*	2

NO ITEM e

f.	Address the country's energy needs						
	May 13-16, 2010	67	25	4	3	*	2

QUESTIONS 5-6 HELD FOR FUTURE RELEASE

ASK ALL:

PEW.7 From what you've seen and heard so far, do you think the Senate should or should not confirm Elena Kagan to the Supreme Court?

Elena Kagan		***Sonia Sotomayor***		***Samuel Alito***			***Harriet Miers***	***John Roberts***	
May 13-16		July	June	Jan	Early Dec	Nov	Early Oct	Mid-Sept	Early Sept
2010		2009	2009	2006	2005	2005	2005	2005	2005
33	Should	50	50	33	32	40	33	46	35
21	Should not	23	25	19	19	23	27	21	19
46	Don't know/Refused	27	25	48	49	37	40	33	46

QUESTIONS 8-10 HELD FOR FUTURE RELEASE

[OPTIONAL: On another subject…]

ASK ALL:

PEW.11 Thinking about financial regulation, what worries you more **[READ AND RANDOMIZE]:**

May13-16 2010	
46	That the government will go too far in regulating financial institutions and markets, making it harder for the economy to grow [**OR]**
44	That the government will not go far enough in regulating financial institutions and markets, leaving the country at risk of another financial crisis
11	Don't know/Refused **(VOL.)**

ASK ALL:
PARTY In politics TODAY, do you consider yourself a Republican, Democrat, or Independent?
ASK IF ANSWERED 3, 4, 5 OR 9 IN PARTY:
PARTYLN As of today do you lean more to the Republican Party or more to the Democratic Party?

	Republican	Democrat	Independent	**(VOL.)** No preference	**(VOL.)** Other party	**(VOL.)** DK/Ref	*Lean Rep*	*Lean Dem*
May 13-16, 2010	23	32	35	6	1	3	14	14